

HP Omen Transcend 14

Packing a Punch in a Feather's Touch!

₹1,75,864



This thin and light gaming laptop review of the HP Omen Transcend 14 is a little different from the rest. Mainly because until now, such laptops were mainly of three kinds. You either had the thin and light laptop with a dedicated GPU but it wasn't a gaming laptop per se. Or you had the thin and light laptop with a really good iGPU, preferably any AMD APU with a Radeon 780M GPU. Third type of laptops are actual gaming laptops with applicable thermals and specifications.

The last category is pretty rare. Because, a thin and light laptop with full-fledged gaming internals and a gross weight of just 1.6kg is rarely seen, because it is a hard combination to pull off. Notably, the ASUS Zephyrus G14 is one similar product, weighing in at just 1.5kg. And now, with the Omen Transcend



14, HP has tried to do just that. So, have they succeeded? Here's my answer.

DESIGN, BUILD QUALITY, KEYBOARD AND I/O

The HP Omen Transcend 14 is a thin and light gaming laptop with compact dimensions, featuring a width of 31.3 cm and a depth of 23.3 cm. Moreover, with just 1.79 cm, the laptop is quite slim. But not slimmer than the 14-inch Alienware gaming laptop which measures just 1.45 cm. The HP Omen 14, however, is also thicker than the ASUS ROG Zephyrus G14, which measures 1.58 cm.

But HP gains ground in terms of weight. The Alienware weighs in at around 1.98 to 2kg. Meanwhile, the HP Omen Transcend 14 is just 1.6kg. Still, it remains 100g heavier than the 2024 ASUS ROG Zephyrus G14, which comes in at around 1.5kg. In short, we can call

the HP Omen Transcend 14 a thin and light gaming laptop but it's not the slimmest, nor the lightest 14-inch computing device on the market.

To achieve a lower gross weight, HP has crafted the A/C/D cover of the device from high-strength aluminium. The A Cover is the top lid with the screen, C Cover includes the keyboard and trackpad area, and D Cover is the bottom with vents and upgrade compartments. I have three main things to say about this design choice.

Firstly, the laptop feels very premium to the touch, secondly, it remains smudge-free during most normal use cases. And thirdly, the top lid feels quite flimsy. The laptop's deck area is quite strong, on the contrary. However, one good thing is that you can lift up the display with a single hand.

In terms of I/O ports, HP has included a very rich variety of ports. The Omen Transcend 14 features a Thunderbolt 4 with USB Type-C offering a 40Gbps signalling rate, supporting USB Power Delivery, DisplayPort 1.4, and HP Sleep and Charge. Also on the list is another USB Type-C port with a 10Gbps signalling rate, also supporting USB Power Delivery, DisplayPort 1.4, and HP Sleep and Charge; two USB Type-A ports with a 10Gbps signalling rate, one of which supports HP Sleep and Charge; a headphone/microphone combo jack; and one HDMI 2.1 port.

Furthermore, the HP Transcend 14 uses a 4-zone RGB backlit Ceramic White keyboard with 26-key Rollover Anti-Ghosting Key technology. Additionally, it features a lattice-less sky-printing keyboard design, which includes keys that have an opaque top and translucent edges. The key design choice makes the backlight show up in a pastel-colour appearance and it looks one-of-a-kind.

HP hasn't given us the official key travel figure but it seems to be more than 1.2mm. The keys also have good spring action and a particularly bouncy feel to them. The sound of the keyboard is also very mellow and premium.

SCREEN AND SPEAKERS REVIEW

The HP Omen Transcend 14 features an